

Maria Silva

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LLB and LLM graduate with practical experience supporting busy legal departments in document production, file management, client communication and deadline tracking. Experienced in managing correspondence and case records, preparing court materials, reviewing documents across concurrent matters and advising clients on procedural requirements. Proficient in Word, Outlook, iManage and electronic filing systems. Background spans real estate disputes, commercial and regulatory matters, and front-line client advisory work.

EDUCATION

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| Comparative and International Dispute Resolution LLM — Merit
Queen Mary University of London | Sept 2024 – Oct 2025 |
| <ul style="list-style-type: none">• Modules in international arbitration, dispute resolution procedure, legal research and evidence analysis• Dissertation: data protection and the development of GDPR across jurisdictions — Distinction, 75% | |
| Law LLB — 2:1
University College London | Sept 2020 – June 2024 |
| <ul style="list-style-type: none">• Modules included Commercial Law, Company Law, Advanced Contract Law and Alternative Dispute Resolution | |
| International Foundation Programme — Law and International Relations
King's College London | Sept 2019 – June 2020 |
| <ul style="list-style-type: none">• Awarded the Leaders of Tomorrow prize (top 20 of a 200-student cohort; partial funding toward undergraduate degree) | |

EXPERIENCE

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| Citizens Advice East Berkshire · Maidenhead
Legal Adviser | July 2026 – Present |
| <ul style="list-style-type: none">• Manages correspondence and case records across housing, welfare, employment, debt and family matters; maintains confidential files and meets submission deadlines• Interviews clients, takes detailed factual statements and establishes chronologies; communicates procedural requirements clearly to individuals in difficult circumstances• Drafts letters, prepares applications and document schedules; researches complex legal points and translates statutory requirements into practical guidance• Assesses eligibility for statutory benefits against regulatory criteria; identifies evidential gaps and advises on next steps | |
| Bryan Cave Leighton Paisner LLP (BCLP) · London
Legal Placement Student — Real Estate Disputes | Feb 2024 – Aug 2024 |
| <ul style="list-style-type: none">• Prepared electronic hearing bundles and court materials; assisted with skeleton arguments and court filings across several concurrent matters• Maintained matter records using iManage; managed large volumes of confidential documents with competing deadlines• Conducted legal and factual research on leasehold issues, easements, rights of light and landlord and tenant disputes• Assisted with hearing arrangements, matter opening and closure, deadline tracking and cost comparisons; prepared client notes | |
| Bryan Cave Leighton Paisner LLP (BCLP) · London
Legal Placement Student — International Arbitration | Aug 2023 – Feb 2024 |

- Reviewed and organised evidence for procedural submissions; drafted procedural orders and procedural histories; maintained structured electronic case files
- Coordinated documents and tracked outstanding actions under time pressure ahead of a significant submission deadline as the sole junior supporting the team
- Liaised with the client on required documents; coordinated with an external translator on Romanian-language materials
- Received feedback from a partner and associate that performance was comparable to a newly qualified solicitor

Q-Legal · London

Oct 2024 – Jan 2025

Legal Adviser

- Managed a data-privacy matter from client instruction through to a formal written advice letter, under a qualified solicitor's supervision
- Researched UK GDPR and Data Protection Act 2018 obligations; identified compliance risks and recommended practical mitigations
- Coordinated with the client and supervising solicitor to meet a fixed deadline; translated complex statutory requirements into clear, commercially focused advice

Adobe · London

June 2022 – Aug 2022

Legal Intern

- Reviewed and amended software licensing agreements; identified contractual risks and assessed alignment with internal legal and compliance requirements
- Liaised with sales, legal and international business teams to resolve contractual queries and reconcile commercial objectives with legal risk
- Reviewed data-processing and confidentiality provisions; researched UK GDPR, EU GDPR and cross-border data transfer requirements
- Prepared and delivered an internal presentation on breach-of-contract risks and mitigation measures

SKILLS

Languages: Portuguese (native), English (fluent), Spanish (basic)

Technical skills: Microsoft Word (document production, audio dictation workflows), Outlook (email and diary management), iManage, legal research databases, electronic court filing portals, electronic bundling, case management and time-recording systems, Microsoft Excel and PowerPoint

Case and evidence management: Document review, hearing bundle preparation, file organisation, deadline tracking, procedural histories, correspondence drafting, client record maintenance